
GRADE**TIME****TOPICS****6–12****15 MINS.**

- Information & Media Literacy
- Digital Citizenship & Literacy
- Artificial Intelligence

What Is AI?

What is artificial intelligence and what are its potential benefits and drawbacks?

Artificial intelligence technology is evolving quickly. Use this short lesson to help students get acquainted with how AI works and consider some of its potential benefits and drawbacks.

For more AI-related lessons, check out the **AI Literacy lesson collection**.

Students will be able to:

OBJECTIVES

- Define what artificial intelligence is.
- Understand what makes generative AI unique.
- Reflect on the benefits and drawbacks of generative AI.

Vocabulary:

artificial intelligence (AI)

a computer program or app that can perform tasks that typically require human intelligence

generative AI

a type of AI that can create content, including text, images, and audio

What You'll Need

Some resources below are available in Spanish

IN CLASS

- Lesson Slides
 - Video: What Is AI?
 - AI Explained Handout Teacher Version
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Lesson Plan

Watch: **What Is AI?**

15 mins.

1. **Ask:** *Have you ever heard about artificial intelligence, or AI? (Slide 4)*

Invite students to share their prior knowledge. If your students are already familiar with artificial intelligence, you can ask the follow-up questions on **Slide 5**.

2. **Say:** *We're going to watch a video that explains what AI is. And we'll talk about a specific kind of AI that is quite popular right now, called generative AI (Slide 6).*

3. Show the **What Is AI?** video (**Slide 7**) and have students complete the active viewing guide on the **AI Explained handout**.

Refer to the **Teacher Version** of the handout to guide the discussion. You can also refer to slides **8–10** and define **generative AI** as *a type of AI that can create content, including text, images, and audio (Slide 10)*.

4. **Say:** *In the video, they mentioned some of the cool things generative AI can do, as well as some of the potential concerns, or things we should look out for when using it. Given what you know, do you think generative AI will be mostly helpful or harmful to society? Pick the side that you agree with the most. Be sure to have at least one reason to support your opinion (Slide 11).*

Note: **This article** provides additional context on the benefits and risks of generative AI.

5. **Have** students position themselves physically to show where they stand, forming a line along one wall. You can also have students share with a thumbs-up/down.

Then review slides **12–15**, inviting students to share their perspectives and add to the reasons that are listed. As students listen to their classmates' perspectives, their own stance may shift. If students have physically located themselves on a line or in different corners of the room, invite them to shift their location to represent any changes in their thinking.

6. **Say:** *Balancing the potential benefits and drawbacks of a new technology can be tricky. When it comes to AI and generative AI, we must think critically about its impacts and remember that we're each in control of how we use it (Slide 16).*



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